

THE SUBSTITUTE TEACHER SURVIVAL BINDER

Everything a Sub Needs in One Place

Templates | Schedules | Procedures

Lesson Plans | Communication Forms

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WELCOME LETTER TEMPLATE

Dear Substitute,

Welcome to my classroom! Thank you for being here. Below is everything you need to have a successful day.

Teacher Name: _____

Grade/Subject: _____

Room Number: _____

School Phone: _____

Principal: _____

Nearest Teacher for Help: _____

Prep Period: _____

Duty Assignment: _____

Lunch Time: _____

End of Day Dismissal: _____

Special Notes: _____

DAILY SCHEDULE

[illegible]

CLASSROOM RULES & EXPECTATIONS

Classroom Rules:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____

Positive Reinforcement System: _____

Consequences for Rule Breaking:

1st offense: _____

2nd offense: _____

3rd offense: _____

Send to office: _____

EMERGENCY PROCEDURES

FIRE: Exit route: _____

Assembly point: _____

LOCKDOWN: Procedure: _____

Lock door? ☐ Yes Hide location: _____

EARTHQUAKE: Procedure: _____

TORNADO: Shelter location: _____

MEDICAL: Nurse location: _____ Phone ext: _____

AED location: _____

INTRUDER: Code word: _____ Action: _____

Emergency contacts:

Office: _____ Principal: _____ Nurse: _____

STUDENT MEDICAL / ALLERGY ALERTS

CRITICAL - Please review before class begins!

Student Name	Condition/Allergy	Action Required

EpiPen location: _____ Inhaler students: _____

BEHAVIOR MANAGEMENT PLAN SUMMARY

Reward System: _____

Class Currency/Points: _____

Signal for Quiet (e.g., hand raise, clap pattern): _____

Transition Signal: _____

Students who may need extra support:

Name: _____ Strategy: _____

Name: _____ Strategy: _____

Name: _____ Strategy: _____

Name: _____ Strategy: _____

If a student is HIGHLY disruptive: _____

RELIABLE STUDENT HELPERS

These students can help with routines, directions, and questions:

[illegible]

TECHNOLOGY INSTRUCTIONS

Computer login - Username: _____ Password: _____

WiFi network: _____ Password: _____

Projector: ☐ Remote ☐ Button Location: _____

SmartBoard instructions: _____

Student devices: ☐ Chromebooks ☐ iPads Cart location: _____

Student login instructions: _____

Classroom phone: Dial ____ for office, ____ for nurse

Printer location: _____

Document camera: ☐ Yes How to use: _____

Classroom website/LMS: _____

WHERE TO FIND SUPPLIES

Extra pencils/pens: _____

Paper: _____

Scissors/glue: _____

Tissues/hand sanitizer: _____

Band-aids: _____

Hall passes: _____

Referral forms: _____

Grade book/attendance: _____

Textbooks: _____

Worksheets for today: _____

Early finisher activities: _____

Sub folder/binder: _____

Keys (if needed): _____

LESSON PLAN - Period/Block 1

Subject: _____ Time: _____ to _____

Objective (what students should learn/do): _____

Materials needed: _____

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Early finishers should: _____

Homework (if any): _____

Collect at end of class: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Notes: _____

LESSON PLAN - Period/Block 2

Subject: _____ Time: _____ to _____

Objective (what students should learn/do): _____

Materials needed: _____

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Early finishers should: _____

Homework (if any): _____

Collect at end of class: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Notes: _____

LESSON PLAN - Period/Block 3

Subject: _____ Time: _____ to _____

Objective (what students should learn/do): _____

Materials needed: _____

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Early finishers should: _____

Homework (if any): _____

Collect at end of class: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Notes: _____

LESSON PLAN - Period/Block 4

Subject: _____ Time: _____ to _____

Objective (what students should learn/do): _____

Materials needed: _____

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Early finishers should: _____

Homework (if any): _____

Collect at end of class: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Notes: _____

LESSON PLAN - Period/Block 5

Subject: _____ Time: _____ to _____

Objective (what students should learn/do): _____

Materials needed: _____

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Early finishers should: _____

Homework (if any): _____

Collect at end of class: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Notes: _____

LESSON PLAN - Period/Block 6

Subject: _____ Time: _____ to _____

Objective (what students should learn/do): _____

Materials needed: _____

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Early finishers should: _____

Homework (if any): _____

Collect at end of class: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Notes: _____

LESSON PLAN - Period/Block 7

Subject: _____ Time: _____ to _____

Objective (what students should learn/do): _____

Materials needed: _____

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Early finishers should: _____

Homework (if any): _____

Collect at end of class: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Notes: _____

LESSON PLAN - Period/Block 8

Subject: _____ Time: _____ to _____

Objective (what students should learn/do): _____

Materials needed: _____

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____

Early finishers should: _____

Homework (if any): _____

Collect at end of class: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Notes: _____

LESSON PLAN - Period/Block 9

Subject: _____ Time: _____ to _____

Objective (what students should learn/do): _____

Materials needed: _____

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Early finishers should: _____

Homework (if any): _____

Collect at end of class: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Notes: _____

LESSON PLAN - Period/Block 10

Subject: _____ Time: _____ to _____

Objective (what students should learn/do): _____

Materials needed: _____

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Early finishers should: _____

Homework (if any): _____

Collect at end of class: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Notes: _____

END-OF-DAY REPORT - Day 1

Date: _____ Sub Name: _____

Overall how did the day go? ☐ Great ☐ Good ☐ Challenging

Lessons completed:

Period 1: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Period 2: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Period 3: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Period 4: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Behavior issues:

Student: _____ Issue: _____

Student: _____ Issue: _____

Positive highlights: _____

Messages/questions for returning teacher: _____

END-OF-DAY REPORT - Day 2

Date: _____ Sub Name: _____

Overall how did the day go? ☐ Great ☐ Good ☐ Challenging

Lessons completed:

Period 1: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Period 2: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Period 3: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Period 4: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Behavior issues:

Student: _____ Issue: _____

Student: _____ Issue: _____

Positive highlights: _____

Messages/questions for returning teacher: _____

END-OF-DAY REPORT - Day 3

Date: _____ Sub Name: _____

Overall how did the day go? ☐ Great ☐ Good ☐ Challenging

Lessons completed:

Period 1: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Period 2: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Period 3: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Period 4: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Behavior issues:

Student: _____ Issue: _____

Student: _____ Issue: _____

Positive highlights: _____

Messages/questions for returning teacher: _____

END-OF-DAY REPORT - Day 4

Date: _____ Sub Name: _____

Overall how did the day go? ☐ Great ☐ Good ☐ Challenging

Lessons completed:

Period 1: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Period 2: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Period 3: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Period 4: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Behavior issues:

Student: _____ Issue: _____

Student: _____ Issue: _____

Positive highlights: _____

Messages/questions for returning teacher: _____

END-OF-DAY REPORT - Day 5

Date: _____ Sub Name: _____

Overall how did the day go? ☐ Great ☐ Good ☐ Challenging

Lessons completed:

Period 1: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Period 2: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Period 3: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Period 4: ☐ Completed ☐ Partially ☐ Not started Notes: _____

Behavior issues:

Student: _____ Issue: _____

Student: _____ Issue: _____

Positive highlights: _____

Messages/questions for returning teacher: _____

IMPORTANT CONTACTS

Principal: _____ Phone/Ext: _____

Vice Principal: _____ Phone/Ext: _____

Office Secretary: _____ Phone/Ext: _____

School Nurse: _____ Phone/Ext: _____

Counselor: _____ Phone/Ext: _____

Special Ed. Teacher: _____ Phone/Ext: _____

Librarian: _____ Phone/Ext: _____

IT Support: _____ Phone/Ext: _____

Custodian: _____ Phone/Ext: _____

Teacher Next Door: _____ Phone/Ext: _____

Department Head: _____ Phone/Ext: _____

Parent Contact (urgent): _____ Phone/Ext: _____

FEEDBACK FORM FOR RETURNING TEACHER

Dear Returning Teacher,

Here is a summary of what happened while you were away:

What went well: _____

What was challenging: _____

Students who were especially helpful: _____

Students who may need follow-up: _____

Assignments collected: ☐ Yes ☐ No Location: _____

Suggestions for future sub plans: _____

TIPS FOR SUCCESSFUL SUBSTITUTE DAYS

- Arrive 15-20 minutes early to review plans
- Introduce yourself and write your name on the board
- Review emergency procedures FIRST
- Check for medical alerts before students arrive
- Follow the teacher's routines as closely as possible
- Be firm but fair - students test subs
- Use the reliable student helpers
- Don't take behavior personally
- Leave detailed notes for the teacher
- Keep your phone number for the teacher to follow up
- If plans run short: read-aloud, silent reading, or journal writing
- If technology fails: have a backup paper activity ready
- Stay positive - your attitude sets the tone!